

Narrowing

Operation	Keystroke	Function	Note
Narrow a buffer region	Emacs narrowing is to restrict display and editing to a portion of a buffer. The remainder of the buffer become temporary inaccessible. If you save the buffer to a file while a portion of the text is narrowed and the rest is invisible, all the buffer content is stored inside the file.  This feature can be confusing to new users, so by default the narrow commands are disabled. However, once understood, narrowing becomes very useful. For example, it become possible to perform a non interactive text replacement on a complete portion of the buffer without impacting the rest. It's also easy to concentrate on a single area of the text. For all those commands, use C-x n w to “ <i>widen</i> ” the region back. Notes: - undo does not widen a narrowed region. (Narrow) shows up in the mode line while narrowing is in effect. - Narrowing affects all windows showing the same buffer. If you want to narrow the text inside one window while continuing to see the entire text of the buffer inside another window, you must create an indirect Buffer in a separate window. Narrowing inside a buffer does not affect its indirect buffers. See § Buffers for more information - Several major modes, like org-mode and markup-mode have extra commands to narrow an area of text. Some minor modes, like lisps-mode, also have commands for narrowing control. Some of these commands are described here but not all. Refer to the documentation of each relevant major mode.		
See also: § Buffers			
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Narrow current function definition	C-x n d	(narrow-to-defun &optional INCLUDE-COMMENTS)	Make text outside current function definition invisible. - The current function definition is the one that contains point or follows point. - Preceding comments are included if INCLUDE-COMMENTS is non-nil. - Works in multiple programming languages (including Elisp, C, Python).
Narrow to marked region	C-x n n	(narrow-to-region START END)	Restrict editing in this buffer to the current region (the area between mark and point).
Narrow to current page	C-x n p	(narrow-to-page &optional ARG)	Narrow to current page. If numeric argument supplied, narrows the page identified by the relative number away from current page.  Pages in Emacs are identified by ASCII formfeed character (treated as whitespace).  To insert a formfeed type: C-q C-l
Widens the narrowed region	To return visibility to buffer area that was hidden by the narrow operation, use the following command.		
Widen a narrowed region	C-x n w	(widen)	Remove restrictions (narrowing) from current buffer. This allows the buffer's full text to be seen and edited.
Org-mode text structure narrowing	The following narrowing control commands are used in Org-mode editing. See § Org-Mode		
Narrow current Org block	C-x n b	(org-narrow-to-block)	Narrow buffer to the current block. Use in Org-mode.
Narrow to current Org element	C-x n e	(org-narrow-to-element)	Narrow buffer to current Org-mode element.
Narrow to Org sub-tree	C-x n s	(org-narrow-to-subtree)	Narrow buffer to the current Org-mode subtree.
Markdown mode narrowing	The following narrowing control commands are used in markdown-mode editing. See § Markdown		
Narrow current block	C-x n b	(markdown-narrow-to-block)	Make text outside current block invisible. The current block is the one that contains point or follows point
Narrow current subtree	C-x n s	(markdown-narrow-to-subtree)	Narrow buffer to the current subtree.
Lispy mode narrowing See § Ix- Lispy	The following narrowing control commands are used in lispy-mode editing. Used to edit Lisp-family code.  This requires the lispy external package.  PEL downloads, installs and activates lispy when the pel-use-lispy user option is set to t.		
Narrow current sexp region	N	(special-lispy-narrow ARG)	Narrow current sexp or region.
Widen	W	(special-lispy-widen)	Widen back to see the complete buffer.
Narrowing with smartparens	 The smartparens external package  is activated by PEL downloads via the pel-use-smartparens user-option. - When the smartparens-mode, a minor mode, is activated the following command is used to focus on the current block. - Use <f11> (((to activate the smartparens-mode.		
Narrow to sexp See: § Ix Smartparens	M-<f7> M-n	(sp-narrow-to-sexp ARG)	Make text outside current balanced expression invisible. - A numeric arg specifies to move up by that many enclosing expressions. - See also ‘narrow-to-region’ and ‘narrow-to-defun’.

Narrowing — Reference

Topic & link	Description
GNU Emacs Lisp Manual - Narrowing	
GNU Emacs Lisp Manual - Point	
Emacs: narrow-to-defun, eval-defun, bug @ ErgoEmacs Old bug - Fixed.	Describe a bug in narrow-to-defun when the elisp code is not formatted properly, which is part of Xah Lee's complaint that Emacs Lisp (and other Lisp) code should be handled truly semantically and it is not; it must conform to the style guide for several tools to work. He reports the bug in Emacs 24.4.1, 23.x. I tried it in Emacs 26.3 and Emacs 26.3 narrow-to-defun works fine . So I assume this issue was fixed since then.